

Internship Reflection

1. My internship over the summer was working for Foster Grant of Essilor Luxottica as an independent contractor creating an in depth marketing competitive analysis for Foster Grant's and their licensed brands competitors. I looked at brand identities, product mix, social media and SWOT for all the brands, then created a detailed presentation and an action plan for Foster Grant. I worked Monday - Friday, 9-5, 3 days a week in office 2 hybrid. I was also tasked with smaller tasks, like creating a consumer insights presentation for July and August and looking at limited collaborations, both potentially for FGX and what other brands in the market were doing.
2. The new things that I learned throughout this internship mainly centered around learning to communicate professionally and effectively, presenting skills, managing timelines and deadlines, and really corporate etiquette and standards as well. On top of that, I was able to learn much more about the process of the retail cycle, being an intern I was able to talk to a lot of different people and learn about how the process evolves from product design to distribution and merchandising, etc., which was interesting to see come to life outside of the classroom. My project being centered around building an in-depth competitive analysis of around 30 brands, allowed me to grow my skills of analyzing the market, market trends, consumer behavior, what is successful v what is not successful with the consumer, etc. which was also really interesting to learn about.
3. The thing that surprised me the most was the independence that I had throughout this whole process. This being my first internship or corporate job, I was not sure what I was getting into exactly and I was expecting a bit more guidance from experienced professionals in the space, but to my surprise I worked on the project very independently,

with few check ins along the way and a final long presentation at the end of the internship to present the team with my findings. I am now grateful for this independence as it forced me to be resourceful to come up with solutions to any problems I might have faced and strengthen my time management skills as I was the only one really managing my workflow and projects.

4. This internship gave me strong practical examples that I can leverage in an interview. For example, from a marketing perspective, I can speak on my ability to conduct a strong and structured analysis of 30 competitive brands, assess market trends, evaluate product strategies, and create SWOT analyses or analyze social media channels and their effectiveness, all of which are important skills looking at a retail or marketing position in the future. From a personal perspective, I can highlight my independence, adaptability, and confidence in presenting my work to a team of professionals. All together, these skills can show that I can think both analytically and creatively.
5. There were a lot of insights that were related to the EMPAC model within my internship as I was conducting a competitive analysis, forcing me to utilize an EMPAC framework to analyze each brand independently and also in comparison to its competitors. I looked a lot at the different brand's pricing and which ones were considered value brands or fashion / designer brands, how and why some brands' higher price points were effective while others were not, in addition to how different brands approached promotions and the success of different promotional strategies. I also looked at matching and how each brand marketed themselves (mainly online and on social media) towards their specific target demographics they were trying to reach. Overall, there's no one specific piece of

information that stood out as related to the EMPAC model, but rather the EMPAC model's overall presence within my project.